

compared to the price of a house or a car. But you are not buying three homes or three cars a day for each member of your household. Because food is a recurring expense, small spending changes can have dramatic effects over time.

This is true in the “extreme frugality” segment of the FI community. Liz, who writes the blog *Frugalwoods*, embraces the concept of saving money on food. She believes cooking from scratch tastes better and is better for you because you determine what ingredients go into your body. Paige and Sam also espouse this principle. Sam said, “eating out is something that never really made sense to me if I could cook and eat something at home.” Paige added, “I literally eat to live, I do not live to eat.”

You may be surprised to hear that controlling food costs is also discussed by higher-spending members of the FI community. Remember, *Physician on FIRE* both lived and ate on his employer’s dime early in his career by receiving per diems while traveling.

Ditto for Jay, the writer of *Slowly Sipping Coffee*. He is half of a pair of six-figure-earning geologists working in the oil and gas industry. He noted that when he and his wife got serious about pursuing FI, they cut out \$24,000 a year in spending. He estimates, “going out to eat was at least thirty to forty percent of that.”